

**HOUSE SUBSTITUTE FOR  
SENATE BILL NO. 81**

A bill to amend 2013 PA 93, entitled  
"Michigan indigent defense commission act,"  
by amending the title and sections 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15, 17, 21,  
and 23 (MCL 780.983, 780.985, 780.987, 780.989, 780.991, 780.993,  
780.995, 780.997, 780.1001, and 780.1003), section 3 as amended by  
2019 PA 108, sections 5, 9, 11, 13, 15, and 17 as amended by 2018  
PA 214, and section 7 as amended by 2018 PA 443, and by adding  
section 14.

**THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF MICHIGAN ENACT:**

TITLE

An act to create the Michigan indigent defense commission and  
to provide for its powers and duties; to provide **certain** indigent  
defendants in criminal **and juvenile** cases with effective assistance



1 of counsel; to provide standards for the appointment of legal  
2 counsel; to provide for and limit certain causes of action; and to  
3 provide for certain appropriations and grants.

4 Sec. 3. As used in this act:

5 (a) "Adult" means either of the following:

6 (i) An individual **who is** 18 years of age or older.

7 (ii) An individual **who is** less than 18 years of age at the time  
8 of the commission of a felony if any of the following conditions  
9 apply:

10 (A) During consideration of a petition filed under section 4  
11 of chapter XIIA of the probate code of 1939, 1939 PA 288, MCL  
12 712A.4, to waive jurisdiction to try the individual as an adult and  
13 upon granting a waiver of jurisdiction.

14 (B) The prosecuting attorney designates the case under section  
15 2d(1) of chapter XIIA of the probate code of 1939, 1939 PA 288, MCL  
16 712A.2d, as a case in which the juvenile is to be tried in the same  
17 manner as an adult.

18 (C) During consideration of a request by the prosecuting  
19 attorney under section 2d(2) of chapter XIIA of the probate code of  
20 1939, 1939 PA 288, MCL 712A.2d, that the court designate the case  
21 as a case in which the juvenile is to be tried in the same manner  
22 as an adult.

23 (D) The prosecuting attorney authorizes the filing of a  
24 complaint and warrant for a specified juvenile violation under  
25 section 1f of chapter IV of the code of criminal procedure, 1927 PA  
26 175, MCL 764.1f.

27 (b) "Consumer Price Index" means the annual United States  
28 Consumer Price Index for all urban consumers as defined and  
29 reported by the United States Department of Labor, Bureau of Labor



1 Statistics.

2 (c) "Department" means the department of licensing and  
3 regulatory affairs.

4 (d) "Effective assistance of counsel" or "effective  
5 representation" means legal representation that is compliant with  
6 standards established by the appellate courts of this state and the  
7 United States Supreme Court.

8 (e) "Indigent" means meeting 1 or more of the conditions  
9 described in section 11(3) **or (4)**.

10 (f) "Indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services" means local legal  
11 defense services provided to a defendant and to which both of the  
12 following conditions apply: **any of the following individuals:**

13 (i) ~~The defendant~~ **An indigent adult who** is being prosecuted or  
14 sentenced for a crime for which ~~an individual~~ **the adult** may be  
15 imprisoned upon conviction, beginning ~~with~~ **not later than** the  
16 ~~defendant's~~ **adult's** initial appearance in court to answer to the  
17 criminal charge.

18 ~~(ii) The defendant is determined to be indigent under section~~  
19 ~~11(3).~~

20 **(ii) An indigent youth who is, or is alleged to be, under the**  
21 **jurisdiction of the court under section 2(a), (d), or (h) of**  
22 **chapter XIIA of the probate code of 1939, 1939 PA 288, MCL 712A.2,**  
23 **beginning not later than the youth's initial appearance in court.**

24 (g) Indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services do not include ~~services~~  
25 ~~authorized to be~~ **either of the following:**

26 **(i) Services** provided under the appellate defender act, 1978 PA  
27 620, MCL 780.711 to 780.719.

28 **(ii) Services** provided by a lawyer-guardian ad litem under  
29 **section 17c(7) to (10) and section 17d of chapter XIIA of the**



**probate code of 1939, 1939 PA 288, MCL 712A.17c and 712A.17d.**

(h) "Indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system" or "~~system~~" means either of the following:

(i) The local unit of government that funds a trial court.

(ii) If a trial court is funded by more than 1 local unit of government, those local units of government, collectively.

(i) "Local share" or "share" means an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system's average annual expenditure for indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services **for adults** in the 3 fiscal years immediately preceding the creation of the MIDC under this act, excluding money reimbursed to the system by individuals determined to be partially indigent, **and indigent defense services for youth in the 3 fiscal years immediately preceding the fiscal year in which the amendatory act that added subdivision (g) (ii) is effective.** Beginning on November 1, 2018, if the Consumer Price Index has increased since November 1 of the prior state fiscal year, the local share must be adjusted by that number or by 3%, whichever is less.

(j) "MIDC" or "commission" means the Michigan indigent defense commission ~~created~~**established** under section 5.

(k) "Partially indigent" means a ~~criminal~~-defendant who is unable to afford the complete cost of legal representation, but is able to contribute a monetary amount toward ~~his or her~~**the** representation.

**(l) "Youth" means an individual who is less than 18 years of age and the subject of a delinquency petition.**

Sec. 5. (1) The Michigan indigent defense commission is established within the department.

(2) The MIDC is an autonomous entity within the department. Except as otherwise provided by law, the MIDC shall exercise its



1 statutory powers, duties, functions, and responsibilities  
 2 independently of the department. The department shall provide  
 3 support and coordinated services as requested by the MIDC including  
 4 providing personnel, budgeting, procurement, and other  
 5 administrative support to the MIDC sufficient to carry out its  
 6 duties, powers, and responsibilities.

7 (3) The MIDC shall propose minimum standards for the local  
 8 delivery of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services providing effective  
 9 assistance of counsel to adults **and youth** throughout this state.

10 ~~These~~

11 (4) **The** minimum standards must be designed to ensure the  
 12 provision of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services that meet  
 13 constitutional requirements for effective assistance of counsel.  
 14 However, these minimum standards must not infringe on the supreme  
 15 court's authority over practice and procedure in the courts of this  
 16 state as set forth in section 5 of article VI of the state  
 17 constitution of 1963.

18 (5) ~~(4)~~The commission shall convene a public hearing before a  
 19 proposed **minimum** standard is recommended to the department.

20 (6) A **proposed** minimum standard ~~proposed under this subsection~~  
 21 must be submitted to the department for approval or rejection.

22 ~~Opposition~~

23 (7) **Any opposition** to a proposed minimum standard may be  
 24 submitted to the department in a manner prescribed by the  
 25 department. ~~An~~ **If an** indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system ~~that~~ objects  
 26 to a ~~recommended~~-**proposed** minimum standard on the ground that the  
 27 ~~recommended~~-**proposed** minimum standard would exceed the MIDC's  
 28 statutory authority, ~~shall~~ **the objection must** state specifically  
 29 how the ~~recommended~~-**proposed** minimum standard would exceed the



1 MIDC's statutory authority. A

2 **(8) Except as otherwise provided in subsection (9), a proposed**  
3 minimum standard is final when it is approved by the department. A

4 **(9) The commission may amend an approved minimum standard at**  
5 **any time in accordance with the procedures set forth in subsections**  
6 **(5) to (8). If a proposed minimum standard has been recommended to**  
7 **the department but not yet approved or rejected, the commission may**  
8 **modify the proposed minimum standard. If the commission modifies**  
9 **the proposed minimum standard under this subsection, the commission**  
10 **must again convene a public hearing before recommending the**  
11 **modified proposed minimum standard to the department.**

12 **(10) An approved** minimum standard ~~that is approved by the~~  
13 ~~department~~ is not subject to challenge through the appellate  
14 procedures in section 15.

15 **(11) An approved minimum standard for the local delivery of**  
16 indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services within an indigent ~~criminal~~  
17 defense system is not a rule as that term is defined in section 7  
18 of the administrative procedures act of 1969, 1969 PA 306, MCL  
19 24.207.

20 **(12) ~~(5) Approval~~ An approval** of a minimum standard proposed  
21 by the MIDC is considered a final department action subject to  
22 judicial review under section 28 of article VI of the state  
23 constitution of 1963 to determine whether the approved minimum  
24 standard is authorized by law. ~~Jurisdiction~~

25 **(13) The jurisdiction** and venue for **the** judicial review of an  
26 **approved minimum standard** are vested in the court of claims.

27 **(14) An indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system may file a petition**  
28 **for the review of an approved minimum standard** in the court of  
29 claims ~~within~~ **not later than** 60 days after the date of mailing **or**



1 **emailing** notice of the department's final decision on the  
 2 ~~recommended~~ **proposed** minimum standard.

3 (15) The filing of a petition for review **under subsection (14)**  
 4 does not stay enforcement of an approved minimum standard, but the  
 5 department may grant, or the court of claims may order, a stay upon  
 6 appropriate terms.

7 (16) ~~(6)~~ The MIDC shall identify and encourage best practices  
 8 for delivering the effective assistance of counsel to indigent  
 9 defendants. ~~charged with crimes.~~

10 (17) ~~(7)~~ The MIDC shall identify and implement a system of  
 11 performance metrics to assess the provision of indigent defense  
 12 services in this state relative to national standards and  
 13 benchmarks.

14 (18) The MIDC shall provide an annual report to the governor,  
 15 **the** legislature, **the** supreme court, and the state budget director  
 16 on the performance metrics not later than December 15 of each year.

17 Sec. 7. (1) The MIDC includes ~~18-19~~ voting members and the ex  
 18 officio member described in subsection ~~(2)-(4)~~.

19 (2) ~~The~~ **Except as otherwise provided in subsection (11), the**  
 20 ~~18-19~~ voting members ~~shall~~ **must** be appointed by the governor for  
 21 terms of 4 years. ~~, except as provided in subsection (4).~~

22 (3) Subject to ~~subsection (3),~~ **subsections (5) to (9),** the  
 23 governor shall appoint **the 19** members ~~under this~~ **described in**  
 24 subsection **(1)** as follows:

25 (a) Two members submitted by the speaker of the house of  
 26 representatives.

27 (b) Two members submitted by the senate majority leader.

28 (c) One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the supreme  
 29 court chief justice.



(d) Three members from a list of 9 names submitted by the Criminal Defense Attorneys of Michigan.

**(e) One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the children's law section of the State Bar of Michigan who is experienced in defending youth in delinquency proceedings.**

**(f)** ~~(e)~~—One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the Michigan Judges Association.

**(g)** ~~(f)~~—One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the Michigan District Judges Association.

**(h)** ~~(g)~~—One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the State Bar of Michigan.

**(i)** ~~(h)~~—One member from a list of names submitted by bar associations whose primary mission or purpose is to advocate for minority interests. Each bar association described in this subdivision may submit 1 name.

**(j)** ~~(i)~~—One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the Prosecuting Attorneys Association of Michigan who is a former county prosecuting attorney or former assistant county prosecuting attorney.

**(k)** ~~(j)~~—One member selected to represent the general public.

**(l)** ~~(k)~~—Two members representing the funding unit of a circuit court from a list of 6 names submitted by the Michigan Association of Counties.

**(m)** ~~(l)~~—One member representing the funding unit of a district court from a list of 3 names submitted by the Michigan Townships Association or the Michigan Municipal League. The Michigan Townships Association and the Michigan Municipal League shall alternate in submitting a list as described under this subdivision. For the first appointment after ~~the effective date of the~~





~~amendatory act that amended this subdivision, March 21, 2019,~~ the Michigan Municipal League shall submit a list as described under this subdivision for consideration for the appointment. For the second appointment after ~~the effective date of the amendatory act that amended this subdivision, March 21, 2019,~~ the Michigan Townships Association shall submit a list as described under this subdivision for consideration for the appointment.

(n) ~~(m)~~—One member from a list of 3 names submitted by the state budget office.

(4) ~~(2)~~—The supreme court chief justice or ~~his or her~~ **the** designee **of the chief justice** shall serve as an ex officio member of the MIDC without vote.

(5) ~~(3) Individuals~~ **Every individual** nominated for service on the MIDC as provided in subsection ~~(1)~~ **(3)** must have **at least 1 of the following:**

(a) ~~significant~~ **Significant** experience in the defense or prosecution of criminal proceedings. ~~or have~~

(b) **Significant experience in the defense or prosecution of youth in juvenile proceedings.**

(c) ~~demonstrated a~~ **A strong and demonstrated** commitment to providing effective representation in indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services.

(6) Of the members appointed under this section, the governor shall appoint no fewer than 2 individuals who are not licensed attorneys **and at least 1 individual with substantial knowledge of the juvenile justice system.**

(7) Any individual who receives compensation from this state or an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system for providing prosecution of or representation to indigent adults **or youth** in state courts is



ineligible to serve as a member of the MIDC.

(8) Not more than 3 judges, whether they are former judges or sitting judges, shall serve on the MIDC at the same time.

(9) The governor may reject the names submitted under subsection ~~(1)~~ (3) and request additional names.

(10) ~~(4)~~ **An** MIDC ~~members~~ **member** shall hold office until ~~their~~ **successors are a successor is appointed for the member.**

(11) The terms of the members must be staggered. Initially, 4 members must be appointed for a term of 4 years each, 4 members must be appointed for a term of 3 years each, 4 members must be appointed for a term of 2 years each, and 3 members must be appointed for a term of 1 year each.

(12) ~~(5)~~ The governor shall fill a vacancy occurring in the membership of the MIDC in the same manner as the original appointment, except if the vacancy is for an appointment described in subsection ~~(1)(d)~~, **(3) (d)**, the source of the nomination shall submit a list of 3 names for each vacancy. However, if the senate majority leader or the speaker of the house of representatives is the source of the nomination, 1 name must be submitted. If an MIDC member vacates the commission before the end of the member's term, the governor shall fill that vacancy for the unexpired term only.

(13) ~~(6) The governor shall appoint 1 of the original MIDC members to serve as chairperson of the MIDC for a term of 1 year. At the expiration of that year, or upon the vacancy in the membership of the member appointed chairperson, the~~ **The** MIDC shall annually elect a chairperson from its membership to serve a 1-year term. An MIDC member shall not serve as chairperson of the MIDC for more than 3 consecutive terms.

(14) ~~(7)~~ MIDC members shall not receive compensation in that



1 capacity but must be reimbursed for their reasonable actual and  
2 necessary expenses by the state treasurer.

3 (15) ~~(8)~~—The governor may remove an MIDC member for  
4 incompetence, dereliction of duty, malfeasance, misfeasance, or  
5 nonfeasance in office, or for any other good cause.

6 (16) ~~(9)~~—A majority of the MIDC voting members constitute a  
7 quorum for the transaction of business at a meeting of the MIDC. A  
8 majority of the MIDC voting members are required for official  
9 action of the commission.

10 (17) ~~(10)~~—Confidential case information ~~—~~including, but not  
11 limited to, client information and attorney work product ~~—~~is  
12 exempt from disclosure under the freedom of information act, 1976  
13 PA 442, MCL 15.231 to 15.246.

14 Sec. 9. (1) The MIDC has the following authority and duties:

15 (a) Developing and overseeing the implementation, enforcement,  
16 and modification of minimum standards, rules, and procedures to  
17 ensure that indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services providing effective  
18 assistance of counsel are consistently delivered to all indigent  
19 adults **and youth** in this state consistent with the safeguards of  
20 the United States ~~constitution~~, **Constitution**, the state  
21 constitution of 1963, and this act.

22 (b) Investigating, auditing, and reviewing the operation of  
23 indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services to ~~assure~~ **ensure** compliance with  
24 the commission's minimum standards, rules, and procedures. However,  
25 an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense service that is in compliance with the  
26 commission's minimum standards, rules, and procedures must not be  
27 required to provide indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services in excess of  
28 those standards, rules, and procedures.

29 (c) Hiring an executive director and determining the



1 appropriate number of staff needed to accomplish the purpose of the  
2 MIDC consistent with annual appropriations.

3 (d) Assigning the executive director the following duties:

4 (i) Establishing an organizational chart, preparing an annual  
5 budget, and hiring, disciplining, and firing staff.

6 (ii) Assisting the MIDC in developing, implementing, and  
7 regularly reviewing the MIDC's standards, rules, and procedures,  
8 including, but not limited to, recommending to the MIDC suggested  
9 changes to the criteria for an indigent adult's **or youth's**  
10 eligibility for receiving ~~criminal~~-trial defense services under  
11 this act.

12 (e) Establishing procedures for the receipt and resolution of  
13 complaints, and the implementation of recommendations from the  
14 courts, other participants in the criminal **and juvenile** justice  
15 ~~system,~~**systems**, clients, and members of the public.

16 (f) Establishing procedures for the mandatory collection of  
17 data concerning the operation of the MIDC, each indigent ~~criminal~~  
18 defense system, and the operation of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
19 services.

20 (g) Establishing rules and procedures for indigent ~~criminal~~  
21 defense systems to apply to the MIDC for grants to bring the  
22 system's delivery of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services into  
23 compliance with the minimum standards established by the MIDC.

24 (h) Establishing procedures for annually reporting to the  
25 governor, **the** legislature, and **the** supreme court. The report  
26 required under this subdivision ~~shall~~**must** include, but **is** not ~~be~~  
27 limited to, recommendations for improvements and further  
28 legislative action.

29 (2) Upon the appropriation of sufficient funds, the MIDC shall



1 establish minimum standards to carry out the purpose of this act,  
 2 and collect data from all indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems. The  
 3 MIDC shall propose goals for compliance with the minimum standards  
 4 established under this act consistent with the metrics established  
 5 under this section and appropriations by this state.

6 (3) In establishing and overseeing the minimum standards,  
 7 rules, and procedures described in subsection (1), the MIDC shall  
 8 emphasize the importance of ~~indigent-criminal~~ **all of the following:**

9 **(a) Indigent** defense services provided to ~~juveniles-youth~~  
 10 under the age of ~~17-18~~ who are tried in the same manner as adults  
 11 or who may be sentenced in the same manner as adults. ~~and to~~

12 **(b) Indigent defense services provided to** adults with mental  
 13 impairments.

14 (4) The MIDC shall be mindful that defense attorneys who  
 15 provide indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services are partners with the  
 16 prosecution, law enforcement, and the judiciary in the criminal **and**  
 17 **juvenile** justice ~~system-systems~~.

18 (5) The MIDC shall establish procedures for the conduct of its  
 19 affairs and promulgate policies necessary to carry out its powers  
 20 and duties under this act.

21 (6) **The** MIDC policies must be placed in an appropriate manual,  
 22 made publicly available on a website, and made available to all  
 23 attorneys and professionals providing indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
 24 services, the supreme court, the governor, the senate majority  
 25 leader, the speaker of the house of representatives, the senate and  
 26 house appropriations committees, and the senate and house fiscal  
 27 agencies.

28 Sec. 11. (1) The MIDC shall establish minimum standards,  
 29 rules, and procedures to effectuate the following:



(a) The delivery of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services must be independent of the judiciary but ensure that the judges of this state are permitted and encouraged to contribute information and advice concerning that delivery of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services.

(b) If the caseload is sufficiently high, indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services may consist of both an indigent ~~criminal~~-defender office and the active participation of other members of the state bar.

(c) ~~Trial courts~~ **A trial court** shall ~~assure~~ **ensure** that each ~~criminal~~-defendant **or youth** is advised of ~~his or her~~ **the** right to counsel. ~~All adults, except those~~ **A defendant or youth may not waive the right to counsel without first consulting with counsel on the consequences of waiver. If a defendant or youth waives the right to counsel, it must be on the record and in writing.**

(d) **Except for a defendant** appearing with retained counsel or ~~those~~ **a defendant** who ~~have~~ **has** made an informed waiver of counsel, ~~must~~ **each defendant must** be screened for ~~eligibility under this act,~~ **indigency using the standards and procedures prescribed by MIDC under subsection (3),** and counsel must be assigned as soon as an indigent ~~adult~~ **defendant** is determined to be eligible for indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services.

(2) The MIDC shall implement minimum standards, rules, and procedures to guarantee the right of indigent defendants to the assistance of counsel as provided under ~~amendment~~ **Amendments VI and XIV** of the Constitution of the United States and section 20 of article I of the state constitution of 1963. In establishing minimum standards, rules, and procedures, the MIDC shall adhere to the following principles:



1 (a) Defense counsel is provided sufficient time and a space  
2 where attorney-client confidentiality is safeguarded for meetings  
3 with defense counsel's client.

4 (b) Defense counsel's workload is controlled to permit  
5 effective representation. Economic disincentives or incentives that  
6 impair defense counsel's ability to provide effective  
7 representation must be avoided. The MIDC may develop workload  
8 controls to enhance defense counsel's ability to provide effective  
9 representation.

10 (c) Defense counsel's ability, training, and experience match  
11 the nature and complexity of the case to which ~~he or she~~ **the**  
12 **defense counsel** is appointed.

13 (d) The same defense counsel continuously represents and  
14 personally appears at every court appearance throughout the  
15 pendency of the case. However, indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems  
16 may exempt ministerial, nonsubstantive tasks, and hearings from  
17 this prescription.

18 (e) Indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems employ only defense  
19 counsel who have attended continuing legal education relevant to  
20 counsels' indigent defense clients.

21 (f) Indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems systematically review  
22 defense counsel at the local level for efficiency and for effective  
23 representation according to MIDC standards.

24 (3) The following requirements apply to the application for,  
25 and appointment of, indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services under this  
26 act:

27 (a) A preliminary inquiry regarding, and the determination of,  
28 the indigency of any defendant, including a determination regarding  
29 whether a defendant is partially indigent, for purposes of this act



1 must be made as determined by the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system  
2 not later than at the defendant's first appearance in court. The  
3 determination may be reviewed by the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
4 system at any other stage of the proceedings. In determining  
5 whether a defendant is entitled to the appointment of counsel, the  
6 indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system shall consider whether the  
7 defendant is indigent and the extent of ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's**  
8 ability to pay. Factors to be considered include, but are not  
9 limited to, income or funds from employment or any other source,  
10 including personal public assistance, to which the defendant is  
11 entitled, property owned by the defendant or in which ~~he or she~~ **the**  
12 **defendant** has an economic interest, outstanding obligations, the  
13 number and ages of the defendant's dependents, employment and job  
14 training history, and ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's** level of  
15 education. A trial court may play a role in this determination as  
16 part of any indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system's compliance plan  
17 under the direction and supervision of the supreme court,  
18 consistent with section 4 of article VI of the state constitution  
19 of 1963. If an indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system determines that a  
20 defendant is partially indigent, the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
21 system shall determine the amount of money the defendant must  
22 contribute to ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's** defense. An indigent  
23 ~~criminal~~-defense system's determination regarding the amount of  
24 money a partially indigent defendant must contribute to ~~his or her~~  
25 **the defendant's** defense is subject to judicial review. Nothing in  
26 this act prevents a court from making a determination of indigency  
27 for any purpose consistent with article VI of the state  
28 constitution of 1963.

29 (b) A defendant is considered to be indigent if ~~he or she~~ **the**





1 **defendant** is unable, without substantial financial hardship to  
 2 ~~himself or herself~~ **the defendant** or to ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's**  
 3 dependents, to obtain competent, qualified legal representation on  
 4 ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's** own. Substantial financial hardship is  
 5 rebuttably presumed if the defendant receives personal public  
 6 assistance, including under the food assistance program, temporary  
 7 assistance for needy families, Medicaid, or disability insurance,  
 8 resides in public housing, or earns an income less than 140% of the  
 9 federal poverty guideline. A defendant is also rebuttably presumed  
 10 to have a substantial financial hardship if ~~he or she~~ **the defendant**  
 11 is currently serving a sentence in a correctional institution or is  
 12 receiving residential treatment in a mental health or substance  
 13 abuse facility.

14 (c) A defendant not falling below the presumptive thresholds  
 15 described in subdivision (b) must be subjected to a more rigorous  
 16 screening process to determine if ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's**  
 17 particular circumstances, including the seriousness of the charges  
 18 being faced, ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's** monthly expenses, and local  
 19 private counsel rates would result in a substantial hardship if ~~he~~  
 20 ~~or she~~ **the defendant** were required to retain private counsel.

21 (d) A determination that a defendant is partially indigent may  
 22 only be made if the indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system determines  
 23 that a defendant is not fully indigent. An indigent ~~criminal~~  
 24 defense system that determines a defendant is not fully indigent  
 25 but may be partially indigent must utilize the screening process  
 26 under subdivision (c). The provisions of subdivision (e) apply to a  
 27 partially indigent defendant.

28 (e) The MIDC shall promulgate objective standards for indigent  
 29 ~~criminal~~ defense systems to determine whether a defendant is



1 indigent or partially indigent. These standards must include  
 2 availability of prompt judicial review, under the direction and  
 3 supervision of the supreme court, if the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
 4 system is making the determination regarding a defendant's  
 5 indigency or partial indigency.

6 (f) The MIDC shall promulgate objective standards for indigent  
 7 ~~criminal~~-defense systems to determine the amount a partially  
 8 indigent defendant must contribute to ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's**  
 9 defense. The standards must include availability of prompt judicial  
 10 review, under the direction and supervision of the supreme court,  
 11 if the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system is making the determination  
 12 regarding how much a partially indigent defendant must contribute  
 13 to ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's** defense.

14 (g) A defendant is responsible for applying for indigent  
 15 defense counsel and for establishing ~~his or her~~ **the defendant's**  
 16 indigency and eligibility for appointed counsel under this act. Any  
 17 oral or written statements made by the defendant in or for use in  
 18 the criminal proceeding and material to the issue of ~~his or her~~ **the**  
 19 **defendant's** indigency must be made under oath or an equivalent  
 20 affirmation.

21 (4) **Except as otherwise provided in this subsection, a youth**  
 22 **is considered to be indigent if the youth is unable, without**  
 23 **substantial financial hardship to the youth, or the youth's parent,**  
 24 **parents, legal guardian, guardians, or custodian, to obtain**  
 25 **competent, qualified legal representation. Substantial financial**  
 26 **hardship is rebuttably presumed if the youth's parent, parents,**  
 27 **legal guardian, guardians, or custodian utilizes personal public**  
 28 **assistance, including under the food assistance program, temporary**  
 29 **assistance for needy families, Medicaid, or disability insurance,**



1 resides in public housing, or earns an income less than 200% of the  
2 federal poverty guideline. The local indigent defense system will  
3 determine if a parent, guardian, or custodian is both willing and  
4 financially able to retain counsel for the youth. The inability of  
5 a youth to obtain parent financial information shall not delay or  
6 prevent appointment of counsel. The income or assets of a parent,  
7 parents, legal guardian, guardians, or custodian shall not be  
8 considered when any of the following apply:

9 (a) The youth is a dual ward, a foster youth, or otherwise in  
10 state care.

11 (b) There is a pending abuse or neglect petition involving the  
12 youth.

13 (c) The offense involves allegations against the parent,  
14 guardian, or custodian.

15 (d) The parent, guardian, or custodian is currently serving a  
16 sentence in a correctional institution or receiving residential  
17 treatment in a mental health or substance abuse facility or is  
18 incapacitated, or the parent's, guardian's, or custodian's  
19 whereabouts are unknown.

20 (e) The requirement to consider the parent, guardian, or  
21 custodian's income would create a conflict of interest or is not  
22 reasonably feasible.

23 (5) ~~(4)~~—The MIDC shall establish standards for trainers and  
24 organizations conducting training that receive MIDC funds for  
25 training and education. The standards established under this  
26 subsection must require that the MIDC analyze the quality of the  
27 training, and must require that the effectiveness of the training  
28 be capable of ~~being measured and validated.~~ **measurement and**  
29 **validation.**



(6) ~~(5)~~ An indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system may include in its compliance plan a request that the MIDC serve as a clearinghouse for experts and investigators. If an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system makes a request under this subsection, the MIDC may develop and operate a system for determining the need and availability for an expert or investigator in individual cases.

Sec. 13. (1) All indigent ~~criminal~~ defense systems and, at the direction of the supreme court, attorneys engaged in providing indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services shall cooperate and participate with the MIDC in the investigation, audit, and review of their indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services.

(2) An indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system may submit ~~to the MIDC~~ an estimate of the cost of developing the plan and cost analysis for implementing the plan under subsection (3) to the MIDC for approval. If approved, the MIDC shall award the indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system a grant to pay the approved costs for developing the plan and cost analysis under subsection (3).

(3) No later than 180 days after a standard is approved by the department, each indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system shall submit a plan to the MIDC for the provision of indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services in a manner as determined by the MIDC and shall submit an annual plan for the following state fiscal year on or before October 1 of each year. A plan submitted under this subsection must specifically address how the minimum standards established by the MIDC under this act will be met and must include a cost analysis for meeting those minimum standards. The standards to be addressed in the annual plan are those approved not less than 180 days before the annual plan submission date. The cost analysis must include a statement of the funds in excess of the local share, if any,



1 necessary to allow its system to comply with the MIDC's minimum  
2 standards.

3 (4) The MIDC shall approve or disapprove all or any portion of  
4 a plan or cost analysis, or both a plan and cost analysis,  
5 submitted under subsection (3), and shall do so ~~within-not later~~  
6 **than** 90 calendar days ~~of-after~~ the submission of the plan and cost  
7 analysis. If the MIDC disapproves any part of the plan, the cost  
8 analysis, or both the plan and the cost analysis, the indigent  
9 ~~criminal~~-defense system shall consult with the MIDC and, for any  
10 disapproved portion, submit a new plan, a new cost analysis, or  
11 both ~~within-not later than~~ 60 calendar days ~~of-after~~ the mailing **or**  
12 **emailing** date of the official notification of the MIDC's  
13 disapproval. If, after 3 submissions, ~~a compromise is not reached,~~  
14 **the MIDC still disapproves of any portion of the plan or cost**  
15 **analysis,** the ~~dispute-disputed~~ portion must be resolved as provided  
16 in section 15. All approved provisions of an indigent ~~criminal~~-  
17 defense system's plan and cost analysis must not be delayed by any  
18 disapproved portion and must proceed as provided in this act. The  
19 MIDC shall not approve a cost analysis or portion of a cost  
20 analysis unless it is reasonably and directly related to an  
21 indigent defense function.

22 (5) The MIDC shall submit a report to the governor, the senate  
23 majority leader, the speaker of the house of representatives, and  
24 the appropriations committees of the senate and house of  
25 representatives requesting the appropriation of funds necessary to  
26 implement compliance plans after all the systems compliance plans  
27 are approved by the MIDC. For standards approved after January 1,  
28 2018, the MIDC shall include a cost analysis for each minimum  
29 standard in the report and shall also provide a cost analysis for



1 each minimum standard approved on or before January 1, 2018, if a  
 2 cost analysis for each minimum standard approved was not provided,  
 3 and shall do so not later than October 31, 2018. The amount  
 4 requested under this subsection must be equal to the total amount  
 5 required to achieve full compliance as agreed upon by the MIDC and  
 6 the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems under the approval process  
 7 provided in subsection (4). The information used to create this  
 8 report must be made available to the governor, the senate majority  
 9 leader, the speaker of the house of representatives, and the  
 10 appropriations committees of the senate and house of  
 11 representatives.

12 ~~(6) The MIDC shall submit a report to the governor, the senate~~  
 13 ~~majority leader, the speaker of the house of representatives, and~~  
 14 ~~the appropriations committees of the senate and house of~~  
 15 ~~representatives not later than October 31, 2021 that includes a~~  
 16 ~~recommendation regarding the appropriate level of local share,~~  
 17 ~~expressed in both total dollars and as a percentage of the total~~  
 18 ~~cost of compliance for each indigent criminal defense system.~~

19 **(6)** ~~(7)~~ Except as provided in subsection ~~(9)~~, **(8)**, an indigent  
 20 ~~criminal~~-defense system shall maintain not less than its local  
 21 share. If the MIDC determines that funding in excess of the  
 22 indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system's share is necessary in order to  
 23 bring its system into compliance with the minimum standards  
 24 established by the MIDC, that excess funding must be paid by this  
 25 state. The legislature shall appropriate to the MIDC the additional  
 26 funds necessary for ~~a~~ **an indigent defense** system to meet and  
 27 maintain those minimum standards, which must be provided to  
 28 indigent ~~criminal~~-defense systems through grants as described in  
 29 subsection ~~(8)~~. **(7)**. The legislature may appropriate funds that

1 apply to less than all of the minimum standards and may provide  
 2 less than the full amount of the funds requested under subsection  
 3 (5). Notwithstanding this subsection, it is the intent of the  
 4 legislature to fund all of the minimum standards contained in the  
 5 report under subsection (5) ~~within~~ **not later than** 3 years ~~of~~ **after**  
 6 the date on which the minimum standards were adopted.

7 **(7)** ~~(8)~~ An indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system must not be  
 8 required to provide funds in excess of its local share. The MIDC  
 9 shall provide grants to indigent ~~criminal~~ defense systems to assist  
 10 in bringing the systems into compliance with minimum standards  
 11 established by the MIDC.

12 **(8)** ~~(9)~~ An indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system is not required to  
 13 expend its local share if the minimum standards established by the  
 14 MIDC may be met for less than that share, but the local share of a  
 15 system that expends less than its local share under these  
 16 circumstances is not reduced by the lower expenditure.

17 **(9)** ~~(10)~~ This state shall appropriate funds to the MIDC for  
 18 grants to the local units of government for the reasonable costs  
 19 associated with data required to be collected under this act that  
 20 is over and above the local unit of government's data costs for  
 21 other purposes.

22 **(10)** ~~(11)~~ **Not later than** 180 days after receiving funds  
 23 from the MIDC under subsection ~~(8)~~, **(7)**, an indigent ~~criminal~~  
 24 defense system shall comply with the terms of the grant in bringing  
 25 its system into compliance with the minimum standards established  
 26 by the MIDC for effective assistance of counsel. The terms of a  
 27 grant may allow an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system to exceed 180  
 28 days for compliance with a specific item needed to meet minimum  
 29 standards if necessity is demonstrated in the indigent ~~criminal~~



1 defense system's compliance plan. The MIDC has the authority to  
 2 allow an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system to exceed 180 days for  
 3 implementation of items if an unforeseeable condition prohibits  
 4 timely compliance.

5 **(11)** ~~(12)~~ If an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system is awarded no  
 6 funds for implementation of its plan under this act, the MIDC shall  
 7 nevertheless issue to the **indigent defense** system a zero grant  
 8 reflecting that it will receive no grant funds.

9 **(12)** ~~(13)~~ The MIDC may apply for and obtain grants from any  
 10 source to carry out the purposes of this act. All funds received by  
 11 MIDC, from any source, are state funds and must be appropriated as  
 12 provided by law.

13 **(13)** ~~(14)~~ The MIDC shall ensure proper financial protocols in  
 14 administering and overseeing funds utilized by indigent ~~criminal~~  
 15 defense systems, including, but not limited to, all of the  
 16 following:

17 (a) Requiring documentation of expenditures.

18 (b) Requiring each indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system to hold  
 19 all grant funds in a fund that is separate from other funds held by  
 20 the indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system.

21 (c) Requiring each indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system to comply  
 22 with the standards promulgated by the ~~governmental accounting~~  
 23 ~~standards board.~~ **Governmental Accounting Standards Board.**

24 **(14)** ~~(15)~~ If an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system does not  
 25 fully expend a grant toward its costs of compliance, its grant in  
 26 the second succeeding fiscal year must be reduced by the amount  
 27 equal to the unexpended funds. Identified unexpended grant funds  
 28 must be reported by indigent ~~criminal~~ defense systems on or before  
 29 October 31 of each year. Funds subject to extension under





1 subsection ~~(11)~~ **(10)** must be reported but not included in the  
 2 reductions described in this subsection. Any grant money that is  
 3 determined to have been used for a purpose outside of the  
 4 compliance plan must be repaid to the MIDC, or if not repaid, must  
 5 be deducted from future grant amounts.

6 **(15)** ~~(16)~~ If an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system expends funds  
 7 in excess of its local share and the approved MIDC grant to meet  
 8 unexpected needs in the provision of indigent ~~criminal~~ defense  
 9 services, the MIDC shall recommend the inclusion of the funds in a  
 10 subsequent year's grant if all expenditures were reasonably and  
 11 directly related to indigent ~~criminal~~ defense functions.

12 **(16)** ~~(17)~~ The court shall collect contribution or  
 13 reimbursement from individuals determined to be partially indigent  
 14 under applicable court rules and statutes. Reimbursement under this  
 15 subsection is subject to section 22 of chapter XV of the code of  
 16 criminal procedure, 1927 PA 175, MCL 775.22. The court shall remit  
 17 100% of the funds it collects under this subsection to the indigent  
 18 ~~criminal~~ defense system in which the court is sitting. Twenty  
 19 percent of the funds received under this subsection by an indigent  
 20 ~~criminal~~ defense system must be remitted to the department in a  
 21 manner prescribed by the department and reported to the MIDC by  
 22 October 31 of each year. The funds received by the department under  
 23 this subsection must be expended by the MIDC ~~in support of indigent~~  
 24 ~~criminal defense systems in this state.~~ **to implement its minimum**  
 25 **standards and to ensure that indigent defense systems comply with**  
 26 **the minimum standards.** The remaining 80% of the funds collected  
 27 under this subsection may be retained by the indigent ~~criminal~~  
 28 defense system for purposes of reimbursing the costs of collecting  
 29 the funds under this subsection and funding indigent defense in the



subsequent fiscal year. The funds collected under this subsection must not alter the calculation of the local share made pursuant to ~~under~~ section 3(i)-3.

**Sec. 14. (1) The MIDC shall not make a grant under section 13 unless the indigent defense system has an approved plan and cost analysis under section 13(4) .**

**(2) The first MIDC grant installment to an indigent defense system is 40% of the system's grant award. The 3 subsequent MIDC grant installments are each 20% of the indigent defense system's grant award.**

**(3) After the first grant installment under subsection (2), the 3 subsequent grant installments are based on the MIDC's review and approval of documentation provided to the MIDC by the indigent defense system, including documentation of expenditures and unexpended funds under section 13(14) and (15). The indigent defense system's documented expenditures for the prior quarter must be not less than 25% of the total plan and cost analysis approved under section 13(4) .**

**(4) The MIDC may allow an indigent defense system to request to be exempt from the requirements under this section for unforeseeable conditions that may prohibit timely expenditure processing by the system.**

**Sec. 15. (1) Except as provided in section 5, if a dispute arises between the MIDC and an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system concerning the ~~requirements of this act, including a dispute concerning the approval of an indigent criminal defense system's~~ annual plan ~~, or~~ cost analysis, ~~or compliance with section 13 or 17,~~ the parties shall attempt to resolve the dispute by mediation. The state court administrator, as authorized by the supreme court,**



1 shall appoint a mediator agreed to by the parties ~~within-not later~~  
 2 **than** 30 calendar days ~~of-after~~ the mailing **or emailing** date of the  
 3 official notification of the third disapproval by the MIDC under  
 4 section 13(4) to mediate the dispute and shall facilitate the  
 5 mediation process. The MIDC shall immediately send the state court  
 6 administrative office a copy of the official notice of that third  
 7 disapproval. If the parties do not agree on the selection of the  
 8 mediator, the state court administrator, as authorized by the  
 9 supreme court, shall appoint a mediator of ~~his or her~~ **the state**  
 10 **court administrator's** choosing. Mediation must commence ~~within-not~~  
 11 **later than** 30 calendar days after the mediator is appointed and  
 12 terminate ~~within-not later than~~ 60 calendar days ~~of-after~~ its  
 13 commencement. Mediation costs associated with mediation of the  
 14 dispute must be paid equally by the parties.

15 **(2) The MIDC shall establish resolution procedures under**  
 16 **section 9(5) related to resolving a dispute with an indigent**  
 17 **defense system that is not in compliance with section 13 or 17. The**  
 18 **procedures must be available on a public website. If a dispute**  
 19 **between the MIDC and an indigent defense system concerning**  
 20 **compliance with section 13 or 17 cannot be resolved through the**  
 21 **MIDC resolution procedures created under this subsection,**  
 22 **subsection (4) applies.**

23 **(3)** ~~(2)~~ If the parties do not come to a resolution of the  
 24 dispute during mediation under subsection (1), all of the following  
 25 apply:

26 (a) The mediator may submit ~~his or her~~ **a** recommendation of how  
 27 the dispute should be resolved to the MIDC ~~within-not later than~~ 30  
 28 calendar days ~~of-after~~ the conclusion of mediation for the MIDC's  
 29 consideration.



(b) The MIDC shall consider the recommendation of the mediator, if any, and shall approve a final plan or ~~the~~ cost analysis, or both, in the manner the MIDC considers appropriate within 30 calendar days, and the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system shall implement the plan as approved by the MIDC.

(c) The indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system that is aggrieved by the final plan, cost analysis, or both, may bring an action seeking equitable relief as described in subsection ~~(3)-(4)~~.

**(4)** ~~(3)~~-The MIDC ~~or~~ an indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system may bring an action seeking equitable relief in the circuit court only as follows:

(a) ~~Within~~ **Not later than** 60 days after the MIDC's issuance of an approved plan and cost analysis under subsection ~~(2)-(b)-(3)(b)~~.

(b) ~~Within~~ **Not later than** 60 days after the system receives grant funds under section ~~13(8)~~, **13(7)**, if the plan, cost analysis, or both, required a grant award for implementation of the plan.

(c) ~~Within~~ **Not later than** 30 days ~~of~~ **after** the MIDC's determination that the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system has breached its duty to comply with ~~an~~ **any of the following**:

**(i) An approved plan.**

**(ii) A cost analysis.**

**(iii) A grant contract provision.**

**(iv) A provision of section 13 or 17.**

(d) The action must be brought in the judicial circuit where the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense ~~service~~-**system** is located. The state court administrator, as authorized by the supreme court, shall assign an active or retired judge from a judicial circuit other than the judicial circuit where the action was filed to hear the case. Costs associated with the assignment of the judge must be



1 paid equally by the parties.

2 (e) The action must not challenge the validity, legality, or  
3 appropriateness of the minimum standards approved by the  
4 department.

5 (5) ~~(4)~~—If the dispute involves the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
6 system's plan, cost analysis, or both, the court may approve,  
7 reject, or modify the submitted plan, cost analysis, or the terms  
8 of a grant awarded under section ~~13(8)~~-**13(7)** other than the amount  
9 of the grant, determine whether section 13 has been complied with,  
10 and issue any orders necessary to obtain compliance with this act.  
11 However, the system must not be required to expend more than its  
12 local share in complying with this act.

13 (6) ~~(5)~~—If a party refuses or fails to comply with a previous  
14 order of the court, the court may enforce the previous order  
15 through the court's enforcement remedies, including, but not  
16 limited to, its contempt powers, and may order that the state  
17 undertake the provision of indigent ~~criminal~~-defense services in  
18 lieu of the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system.

19 (7) ~~(6)~~—If the court determines that an indigent ~~criminal~~-  
20 defense system has breached its duty under section 17(1), the court  
21 may order the MIDC to provide indigent ~~criminal~~-defense on behalf  
22 of that **indigent defense** system.

23 (8) ~~(7)~~—If the court orders the MIDC to provide indigent  
24 ~~criminal~~-defense services on behalf of an indigent ~~criminal~~-defense  
25 system, the court shall order the system to pay the following  
26 amount of the state's costs that the MIDC determines are necessary  
27 ~~in order to~~ bring the indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system into  
28 compliance with the minimum standards established by the MIDC:

29 (a) In the first year, 20% of the state's costs.



(b) In the second year, 40% of the state's costs.

(c) In the third year, 60% of the state's costs.

(d) In the fourth year, 80% of the state's costs.

(e) In the fifth year, and any subsequent year, not more than the dollar amount that was calculated under subdivision (d).

(9) ~~(8)~~ An indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system may resume providing indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services at any time as provided under section 13. When ~~a~~ **an indigent defense** system resumes providing indigent ~~criminal~~ defense services, it is no longer required to pay an assessment under subsection ~~(7)~~ **(8)** but must be required to pay no less than its share.

Sec. 17. (1) Except as provided in subsection (2), every local unit of government that is part of an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system shall comply with an approved plan under this act.

(2) ~~A~~ **An indigent defense** system's duty of compliance with 1 or more standards within the plan under subsection (1) is contingent upon receipt of a grant in the amount sufficient to cover that particular standard or standards contained in the plan and cost analysis approved by the MIDC.

(3) The MIDC may proceed under section 15 if an indigent ~~criminal~~ defense system breaches its duty of compliance under subsection (1).

Sec. 21. Both of the following apply to the MIDC:

(a) ~~The~~ **Except as provided in section 7(17), the** freedom of information act, 1976 PA 442, MCL 15.231 to 15.246. ~~, except as provided in section 7(10).~~

(b) The open meetings act, 1976 PA 267, MCL 15.261 to 15.275.

Sec. 23. (1) Nothing in this act shall be construed to overrule, expand, or extend, either directly or by analogy, any



1 decisions reached by the United States ~~supreme court~~ **Supreme Court**  
 2 or the supreme court of this state regarding the effective  
 3 assistance of counsel.

4 (2) Nothing in this act shall be construed to override section  
 5 29 or 30 of article IX of the state constitution of 1963.

6 (3) Except as otherwise provided in this act, the failure of  
 7 an indigent ~~criminal~~-defense system to comply with statutory duties  
 8 imposed under this act does not create a cause of action against  
 9 the government or a system.

10 (4) ~~Statutory~~ **The** duties imposed **under this act** that create a  
 11 higher standard than that imposed by the United States ~~constitution~~  
 12 **Constitution** or the state constitution of 1963 do not create a  
 13 cause of action against a local unit of government, an indigent  
 14 ~~criminal~~-defense system, or this state.

15 (5) ~~Violations~~ **A violation** of **the** MIDC rules that ~~do~~ **does** not  
 16 constitute ineffective assistance of counsel under the United  
 17 States ~~constitution~~ **Constitution** or the state constitution of 1963  
 18 ~~do~~ **does** not constitute grounds for a conviction to be reversed or a  
 19 judgment to be modified for ineffective assistance of counsel.

20 Enacting section 1. This amendatory act takes effect October  
 21 1, 2027.